

June

23

1281

Divine wind

Mongol forces arrived in Hakata Bay off Kyūshū island in an attempt to invade Japan. But the Mongol armada was nearly destroyed by a typhoon, forcing them to retreat. This was the second Mongol invasion of Japan to be foiled by bad weather, leading the Japanese to believe they had been saved by divine winds, or *kamikaze*.



Also on this day

1757 The British East India Company defeated the Nawab of Bengal at the Battle of Plassey, gaining control over the region.

1894 The International Olympic Committee was founded in France, with members from 13 countries. It organized the first modern Olympic Games in 1896, and continues to arrange the Olympics every four years.

2016 In a historic public vote, 52 per cent of the UK's population chose to leave the European Union.

1961

Protecting Antarctica

Twelve countries came together to enforce the Antarctic Treaty, which banned military activity on the continent and encouraged peaceful cooperation between the nations in scientific research carried out in Antarctica.



Born this day

1912 Alan Turing, British mathematician. Among the greatest scientific minds of the 20th century, he is best known for breaking encrypted German codes during World War II, and for his work in developing computer science.